



Fig. 2: Use of CAPTCHA to authenticate the user for access

trying to infiltrate your services by using automated programs (bots) to access the Internet, affecting a large number of users in their daily work. For example, e-mail service might itself be bombarded by requests from an automated system sending spam mails over the servers. So CAPTCHA here identifies between the requests from human beings and automated programs and prevents the access to these automated programs.

How CAPTCHA works

In general, first of all, a random value is created as random values are often hard to guess and predict. Then an image is generated, as visual data is quite hard to process by the computers but provides ease of readability to the human beings. The developer employs a high level of

complexity so that the image cannot be cracked. This generated text image is then stored.

Later, the user is asked to enter CAPTCHA. If the entered CAPTCHA matches with the stored CAPTCHA, the user is allowed to access, login or submit the form. This is well illustrated in Fig. 2.

Areas of use

There are lots of areas in which CAPTCHA is currently used. These include protecting website registration, protecting e-mail addresses from scrapers, preventing automated programs from corrupting online polls, preventing comment spam in blogs, and preventing search engine bots from reading webpages.

CAPTCHA is undoubtedly a very reliable test in most Web applications. The developers are continuously working to take this very gift of artificial intelligence to new levels, leaving bots far behind. ●

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